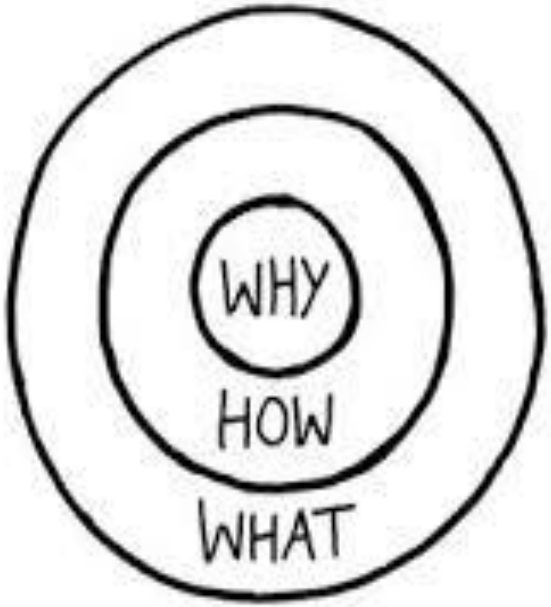
STARTUP WISE GUYS

Pitch Training Framework

The SWG pitch training blueprint

December 2020

Where do we start?



- **What** pitch trainings and strategies should we be training the teams in and in what order?
- **How** do we help the teams as part of:

  -> The accelerator

  -> 6 months after the program

  -> Post accelerator (long-term)
- **Why** the SWG framework will lead to highly successful startups

What is the Pitch Training Chocolate formula?

6 Pillars

1 Bonus Track

📈 = {🤔 + 🕵️ + 🎯 + 🚀 + 💻 + 📊 +❤️+ 🔁}

SWG PITCHING FORMULA

Pillar 1

Set yourself up ONLINE & ONSITE 🎯

Presentation
Awareness

Online Week 3-6
Onsite week 10+

Pillar 2

Elevator pitch 💻

Learning to make a short intro of what you do & why

Week 3-6

Pillar 3

Storytelling 🚀

Within 3 weeks after Pillar 2

Pillar 4

The Pitch Deck 💻

Linking storyline & pitch into a powerful supporting deck

Weeks 9-11

Pillar 5

Pitch Delivery 📊

Close deals and build revenue

Not earlier than demo day – 3 weeks

Pillar 6

Data Driven Q&A 📊

How to survive and thrive during a live Q&A

Not earlier than demo day – 4 weeks

Bonus Track

Delivering a killer demo pitch 📊

After Market engineering sprint

SWG 📈 BATCH TIME VIEW

Week 0

Progress Day
Program Week 10-11
Content Week 6-7

Demo Day
Program Week 20-22
Content Week 13

MODULE 1 → **MODULE 2** → **MODULE 3** → **MODULE 4**

P2 – Elevator Pitch
MD & PM
Week 1-3

P3 – Foundation of Storytelling
Ginny Radmall/Anna Boon
Week 5—7

P6- Data Driven & Q&A
Gleb Maltsev
Week 10-11

P1 - Presentation Online
Anna Boon/Sudha Kheterpal
Week 2-4

Bonus – Killer Demo Pitch
Karina Lapina
Week 6-8

P1 - Stage Presence
Dan le Man
Week 11-12

P4 – Pitch Deck
MD/PM/Zane Bojare
Week 6-9

P5 – Pitch delivery
Dan le Man/Ginny Radmall
Week 12-13

SWG PITCHING FORMULA

Pillar #	Description	Proven Coaches (first choice)	Other Options	Preferred Content Weeks	Other
1	**Set yourself up ONLINE**	Anna Boon	Sudha Kheterpal	Week 2-4	Online batches that move Onsite 2nd part of the batch
	Set yourself up ONSITE /Stage Presence	Dan Le Man		Week 11-12	
2	**Elevator Pitch**	Batch MD – PM		Week 1-3	
3	**Foundation of Storytelling**	Ginny Radmall	Gleb Maltsev, Anna Boon, Zane Bojare (SWG)	Week 5-7	
4	**Pitch Deck**	Batch MD – PM	Zane Bojare (SWG), Karina Lapina (SWG)	Week 6-9	
5	**Pitch Delivery**	Dan le Man Ginny Radmall	Anna Boon, Gleb Maltsev	Week 12-13	
6	**Data Driven Q&A**	Gleb Maltsev	Batch MD – PM	Week 10-11	
BONUS	**Killer Demo Pitch**	Karina Lapina (SWG)	Patrick Collins (SWG), Uldis Zeidurs (SWG)	**ALIGN WITH SALES**	

Pillar 1 – Set yourself up ONLINE

What it covers

+ Online Presentation
+ Online Awareness
+ Online Grounding

Possible formats and duration

+ 1 hour all teams workshop
+ One2one coaching
+ Offer resource packs for candidates plus written individual feedback

What do teams get

+ Captivate has helped hundreds of startups present themselves brilliantly on screen - for media calls, investor meetings and recorded pitches
+ The techniques we coach focus on how to create the level of energy you need when presenting online so that you stand out from the crowd

How will they improve 6 months after the program

+ This will help with the longevity of the coaching, which I see is part of the outlined objective. Candidates are also welcome to contact us to ask questions and for pointers, (within reason)

Anna Boon

Pitch trainer

- **Experience**: Anna spent years touring the globe as an actress before founding Captivate Coaching. She is now passing the skills she learnt on stage and screen on to business people who really need them. Her greatest joy is in helping people develop and reach their potential in the field of communication.
- **Fun Fact:** When she is not coaching, Anna helps run a theatre company who specialize in devising and new writing. She also loves cooking, making fires and extreme sports.

Can help with: present themselves brilliantly on screen - for media calls, investor meetings and recorded pitches. The techniques we coach focus on how to create the level of energy you need when presenting online so that you stand out from the crowd.

LinkedIn
anna@captivatecoaching.co.uk

Sudha Ketherpal

Pitch trainer

- **Experience**: is a world-renowned musician and has enjoyed huge global success for 25 years performing as a percussionist with bands such as Faithless, The Spice Girls and Kylie Minogue. She is also a two times TED X speaker and has received multiple awards for her entrepreneurial endeavors. As a Startup founder herself, Sudha is passionate about helping Startups pitch to win investment and business. She provides pitch coaching using a methodology that has helped 1000+ Startups raise 300 million euros.

LinkedIn
xxx@xxx.xx

Pillar 1 – Set yourself up ONSITE

What it covers

+ Presentation
+ Awareness
+ Grounding

Possible formats and duration

+ Ideally bar or stage type location (eg Heldeke in Tallinn)
+ 3-4 hours all teams workshop

What do teams get

They will be able to:

+ Build trust with their audience
+ Be comfortable under pressure
+ Be aware of their body language and intonation (and what information they send)
+ Be their honest selves when in the spotlight
+ Find their own unique pitching style
+ Use offline and online environments to their advantage

How will they improve 6 months after the program

+ Pitching will become a natural, positive and fun experience every time they need to do it. Online and offline.
+ They'll be aware of the variables in each situation and be able to tailor-make their pitch to suit specific environments.

Dan le Man

Comedian turn lightly 2 coach

- **Experience**: Has studied circus and theatre with 20+ years practical performance experience in 35+ countries. Has been pitch coaching with incubators and accelerator programs plus running public speaking courses at universities for the last 5 years.
- **Super Power**: Removing mental blocks and building the "Yes Let's Do It" attitude
- **Fun Fact:** Traveled the Trans-Siberian railway busking with his ukulele

Can help with: your stage presence, delivery, content and awareness to make you versatile and comfortable in all pitching situations

LinkedIn
dan@dan-le-man.com

Pillar 2 – Elevator Pitch

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What it covers & format

2 days

+ Group workshop 1 – Coaching the founders to effectively and shortly pitch their value proposition and USP in a short intro (elevator pitch)
+ 1-1's with the founder who will be pitching (secondary pitcher should join these sessions to observe feedback that is being given in case they will pitch at a later stage), 1 hour per 1-1

+ **MD and PM driven after Module 1**

What do teams get

+ How to pitch your value proposition and USP
+ Being specific, clear and direct
+ An initial way to practice their Pillar 1 learnings
+ Proven facts and not using jargon, a pitch your mother can understand and lead to a longer conversation
+ A clear and defined way to introduce themselves to mentors and coaches going forward until 3m pitch is delivered

Pillar 3 – Foundation of Storytelling

STARTUP WISE GUYS

What it covers & format

2 days

+ Group workshop 1 - Laying the foundation for pitching and storytelling, 2 hours
+ 1-1's with the founder who will be pitching (secondary pitcher should join these sessions to observe feedback that is being given in case they will pitch at a later stage), 1 hour per 1-1

What do teams get

+ How to pitch the story of what you do in a compelling way (problem and solution)
+ Mistakes to avoid i.e. using too much jargon, waffling, lacking credibility and how to be succinct
+ Specific feedback for each founder on getting rid of unnecessary language and telling the story from the end-user's perspective

Ginny Radmall

Director, The Ivy Way

- **Experience:** 7 years experience working with corporates like Google and Microsoft, and with Startup Accelerators such as SWG, Startupbootcamp, Techstars and Mass Challenge. Coaches over 1,000 founders a year around the world on how to deliver a memorable pitch on stage and virtually
- **Super power:** Taking people out of their comfort zone and turning them into powerful communicators
- **Fun fact:** Is an identical triplet and originally trained and worked as an actress
- **Can help with:** Pitch delivery and pitch content. Sales training, conflict coaching and team building

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Pillar 4 – Pitch Deck

What it covers and format

+ Following up from the market engineering sprint and the storyline pillar, teams will have to develop an **initial pitch deck to support their story and 3m pitch**
+ **Group workshop 1** – How to build an effective deck, mainly using examples from past batches and DO´s and DON'T
+ **Several 1-1's** with MD and PM and the founders to give feedback until a decent version 1.0 is created

What do teams get

+ Tips on how simple, supportive and clear decks are created
+ Mistakes to avoid
+ Specific feedback for each founder on best supporting their story from a pitch deck pov

Teams DON'T get

+ Support from a designer to build a beautiful deck

Pillar 5 – Pitch Delivery

What it covers

2 days

+ Group workshop 2 - Fine tuning and pitch delivery 2 hours
+ 1-1's with the founder (again with secondary pitcher in the room)

What do teams get

+ How to deliver your pitch whether in person or over video
+ Posture, breathing, diction, vocal technique
+ Best practise for speaking to a camera (this can then be applied for webinars, sales calls etc).
+ Specific feedback on any habits the founder has and exercises/techniques to overcome them
+ Coaching around energy and authority when speaking

How will they notice 6 months after the program

+ Pitching will become a natural, positive and fun experience every time they need to do it. Online and offline.
+ They'll be aware of the variables in each situation and be able to tailor-make their pitch to suit specific environments.

Dan le Man

Comedian turn lightly 2 coach

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LinkedIn
dan@dan-le-man.com

Pillar 6 – Data Driven Q&A

STARTUP WISE GUYS

What it covers and format

2 days

+ Group workshop — Fundamentals of story-driven conversations, 4 hours
+ 1-4 group coaching — Structured sparring sessions in more intimate groups. It's meant for both primary and secondary presenters to prepare for the hard part of the pitch, 1-2 hours

What do teams get

+ Guided peer review, feedback, and learning
+ Practical practice-focused stress test to identify red flags in a verbal pitch or deck
+ Data-driven tools to handle hard conversations with investors on stage and off it (applies to prospects as well)
+ An analysis of and customized feedback on the whole pitch 'package' before going out in the field

How will teams notice 6 months after the program

+ They'd be less likely to 'lose it' on stage and off it
+ More likely to reframe hard questions
+ Would be more likely to predict and confidently answer FAQs thrown their way
+ Make sense of their narrative through deeper probing questions

Gleb Maltsev

Data-Driven Pitch Coach

- **Experience:** Has trained thousands of people during the past ten years - founders, salespeople, engineers, designers, and scientists. His alumni have pitched in the finals of Slush, Latitude59, TechChill, sTARTUp Day, and LOGIN. He co-founded a crowdfunding platform and trained founders at SWG since 2012.
- **"Superpower":** Has spent years actively listening to speakers. Can deconstruct, reassemble, and deliver almost any pitch after a 10-minute live conversation in front of hundreds of people.
- **Fun fact:** Learned how to sew a suit jacket. Has a VO2 max score of 61 mL/kg/min. Loves running, sci-fi, comics and cats.

- **Can help with**: pitching, story, visuals, Q&A, warm intros

LinkedIn
gleb@fundwise.me

Bonus Track – Killer Demo Pitch

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What it covers

+ Demonstration of the working product or prototype
+ Improvement of sales processes

What do teams get

+ How do show the product benefits, short and clear
+ How to do the device/platform agnostic demonstration online via a zoom call
+ How to be prepared for giving a smooth demonstration and avoid technical gaps and failures
+ How to let the CTO not screw up all the demos and impress potential customers/investors

Possible formats and duration

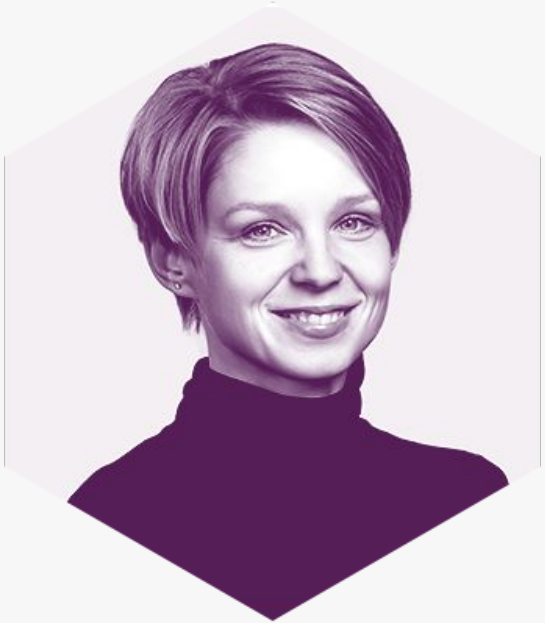
+ Session on how to run the demonstration, possible formats, and how to avoid typical failures (40 min)
+ 1to1 demo review with tech coaches with feedback, help in defining strong parts of product (Uldis, Karina) - 30 min per team (10min demo, 20min discussion & feedback)
+ Demo drill with other participants, peers feedback (approx. 1h per 5 teams)

How will they notice 6 months after the program

+ Decrease amount of time in the sales cycle
+ Will spend less time on explaining and convincing the clients
+ Revenue/number of clients growth
+ CTO and salespeople in the team will feel more comfortable with showing product to the clients, will likely go more often to do that

Karina Lapina

Head of Scouting, SWG



- **Experience:**
- **Super power:**
- **Fun fact:**
- **Can help with:**

LinkedIn
email

Supporting the teams better in the program – MD and PM ownership

During the program

- Mark the person pitching against certain 'pitching competencies' or criteria so they have a sense of their progress and where they need to get to
- Provide the founders with videos of them pitching at various points in the program to be used as a learning tool
- Each founder could receive a bespoke worksheet of exercises to work through after their 1-1 coaching sessions*
- If they have two 1-1 sessions during the course of the program, then they will have 'homework'/ tasks to complete before the next session
- Each founder could also receive a Resource Pack of books, articles and TED talks which signpost them towards continuously improving their pitch or communication style *

** WORK IN PROGRESS – INITIAL OWNERSHIP UNDER BLUEPRINT*

The SWG roles

El patron role: The Glue, The Finisher, Just What You Need and On Point Feedback and Motivation

MD Role: Challenger, Brainstormer, Tracker, Carrot and a Stick
PM Role: Kicker, Controller, Crying Shoulder

Program responsibilities

+ Assuring each company has at least 2 people trained to pitch
+ Train startups on the elevator (30-60 sec) pitch, before founders start working with pitch coaches on content and delivery
+ Provide at least 8 pitch training sessions per founder during the program (minimum 4 program trainings with external coaches and minimum 4 internal pitch practices, involving SWG team & P2P feedback)
+ Provide founders with feedback on Pitch Scripts

MD responsibilities

- Assure that each company has at least 2 people trained to pitch
- Train startups on the elevator (30-60 sec) pitch, before founders start working with pitch coaches on content and delivery
- Deliver best-practice and support on developing the initial pitch deck once the storyline of the pitch is developed
- Provide founders with feedback on Pitch Scripts